(ii) Advantages and Disadvantages of Fly ash bricks

Advantages

1. It reduces dead load on structures due to light weight (2.6 kg, dimension: 230 mm X 110 mm X 70 mm).
2. High fire Insulation.
3. Due to high strength, practically no breakage during transport and use.
4. Due to uniform size of bricks, mortar required for joints and plaster reduces almost by 50%.
5. Due to lower water penetration, seepage of water through bricks is considerably reduced.
6. Gypsum plaster can be directly applied on these bricks without a backing coat of lime/cement plaster.
7. These bricks do not require soaking in water for 24 hours. Sprinkling of water before use is enough.

Disadvantages

1. Mechanical strength is low, but this can be rectified by adding mortar between blocks.
2. Limitation of size. Only modular size can be produced. Large size will have more breakages.
3. It is only good for the places like subtropical area or area where climate is warm because it doesn't absorb heat. But during cold it is not helpful.

2.8.4 Plaster of Paris

It is a kind of hydrated gypsum. When mixed with water, it slakes and generates heat and expands to certain extent. It is milky white in color and used for making moulds, filling gaps in masonry and plaster. It is mainly used for decorative false ceiling works in all types of buildings.







(i) Advantages and Disadvantages of Plaster of Paris

The following are the advantages of using Plaster of Paris.

1. It does not shrink while setting and thus avoids cracks.
2. It is durable and light weight.
3. It combines well with paint and helps in decoration of walls.
4. It is easily workable as it mixes with water.

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